# Project Plan Template · Expert version

A project plan template brings the essentials of a project into one place: goals, scope, deliverables, tasks, owners, dates and milestones. Use it to plan the work, agree it with stakeholders and track progress.

## How to use this template

1. Fill in the Overview tab: goal, scope, deliverables, budget and success criteria.
2. Break the work into phases and tasks on the Project plan tab, using a work breakdown structure.
3. Give every task one owner, a start date and an end date; the duration calculates automatically.
4. Record dependencies so you can see which tasks must finish first.
5. Mark key milestones and agree the plan with your sponsor before work starts.
6. Update the Status column weekly and use it in your status report.

## Tips

• Plan at a level of detail you can actually keep up to date.
• Add buffer to risky tasks rather than padding every estimate.
• Keep the plan visible: share the link instead of emailing copies.
• Re-baseline only through change control.

## Dashboard (sample data)

| Field | Value | Count |
|---|---|---|
| Owner | Business analyst | 1 |
| Owner | Delivery team | 1 |
| Owner | Project manager | 4 |
| Owner | Sponsor | 1 |
| Status | Not started | 4 |
| Status | In progress | 1 |
| Status | On hold | 0 |
| Status | Blocked | 0 |
| Status | Done | 2 |

## Project plan · Tasks, owners, dates and dependencies

| ID | Phase | Task / deliverable | Owner | Start | End | Duration (days) | Depends on | Status | Milestone? |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1.1 | Initiation | Project charter approved | Sponsor | 5 Jan 2026 | 9 Jan 2026 | 5 | | Done | Yes |
| 1.2 | Initiation | Stakeholder register | Project manager | 7 Jan 2026 | 12 Jan 2026 | 6 | 1.1 | Done | |
| 2.1 | Planning | Requirements workshop | Business analyst | 13 Jan 2026 | 16 Jan 2026 | 4 | 1.2 | In progress | |
| 2.2 | Planning | Work breakdown structure | Project manager | 19 Jan 2026 | 21 Jan 2026 | 3 | 2.1 | Not started | |
| 2.3 | Planning | Schedule and budget baseline | Project manager | 22 Jan 2026 | 28 Jan 2026 | 7 | 2.2 | Not started | Yes |
| 3.1 | Execution | Build release 1 | Delivery team | 2 Feb 2026 | 13 Mar 2026 | 40 | 2.3 | Not started | |
| 4.1 | Closure | Handover and lessons learned | Project manager | 16 Mar 2026 | 20 Mar 2026 | 5 | 3.1 | Not started | Yes |
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## Overview · One-page summary of the plan

| Item | Details |
|---|---|
| Project name | |
| Sponsor | |
| Project manager | |
| Goal (SMART) | e.g. Launch the customer portal by 31 March to cut support calls by 30% |
| In scope | |
| Out of scope | |
| Key deliverables | |
| Budget | |
| Key risks | |
| Success criteria | |
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